PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS

Connect • Serve • Change Lives

2018 Administrative Guide

Last Revised January 2018.

This manual has been prepared to help you become acquainted with Partners' procedures and administrative procedures, and to answer questions common to new and continuing employees. Feel free to ask for any additional information from your supervisor or from the Finance Office.

Periodic revisions are expected. Questions and suggestions are welcome and should be provided to the Finance and Administration Office. Employees are free to ask about interpretations or to suggest changes at any time. Partners' reserves the right to revise any procedure or guideline described in this document without notice.

Thank you!

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Travel Related

Staff Travel Guidelines

Following are definitions and requirements to be observed by Partners' staff (and in many cases by consultants and Board members working on special assignments) traveling under Partners direction and funding.

Allowable expenses and reimbursement limitations

Partners' travel expense reimbursement policy is based upon actual expenses within reason for the travel as defined by the US Government per diem rates. While Partners' does not strictly follow the expense ceilings as defined by the per diem rates for the US Government, they should be used as a guideline for allowable expenditures. Furthermore, only allowable expenses are reimbursable. No later than 30 days following a trip, an Expense Reimbursement Report should be prepared and submitted to the Finance Office. The Finance Office will not accept reimbursement requests made after 60 days unless approved by Senior Management with valid reasoning in writing to F&A.

Allowable costs and rates are based on US Government allowances. Updated information regarding rates is available via the web:

Domestic per diem rates (www.gsa.gov/HP_01Trvl_perdiem)

Foreign per diem rates (http://aoprals.state.gov/web920/per_diem.asp)

Lodging

- Lodging – included in this group are room charges and taxes. Partners will recognize and reimburse lodging costs based on actual expenses, but the ceiling rates should be a guide to appropriate expenditures per country.

Meals and Incidentals

- Partners will pay or reimburse meals and incidental expenses based on actual expenses, but the U.S. government ceiling rates should be a guide to appropriate expenditures per country.

Alcohol purchases:

- Alcohol purchases are not encouraged. However in cases where there is clear justification for alcohol purchases along with support from the respective team leaders, the organization will have to fund these purchases from its internal Administrative Funds and is unallowable as a regular program cost. All alcohol purchases made for reasonable Partners business can only be charged under administrative departments to object code 8402 – Unallowable Program Costs. By charging these items to 8402, they will be excluded from any POA NICRA calculation and thus a hard cost to the Administrative Budget. Please note you will need to split the alcohol from the total bill and exclude the cost (not including tax, unless there is a specific liquor tax).

Personal purchases:

- Personal purchases should not be made on company credit cards. However, in the event that a mistaken charge is made, the expense should be reimbursed to Partners upon submitting the credit cards statement. On the credit card expense report, the personal expense will be coded to 1201, and the expense must be reimbursed with cash, check, or credit/debit card. If desired to pay via credit/debit card, please let F&A know and they will generate an electronic invoice.

Allowable expenses that may be submitted for reimbursement as described above are all reasonable costs which are essential and directly related to the objectives of the grant and/or the main purpose of the trip. Included in the category are costs such as transportation, visas, immunizations, medications on travel, food, lodging, laundry and dry cleaning, reproduction of materials, communications and other allowable expenses as defined by OMB circulars. Allowable expenses are also limited to the conditions established on grants and agreements with funding agencies sponsoring the trip.*

Expense reports can be found on the J:\Administration - Finance\FORMS, Requests, and Templates

*Please reference list of non-reimbursable expenses listed below.

Requesting authorization

Staff considering a trip should discuss it with his/her supervisor as to the need for the trip, activities to be conducted, funding for related costs, expectations, etc. (Partners' President will notify the Board about his/her travel plans). Subsequently, the following documentation must be prepared.

Use of Travel Authorizations

Effective August 1st, 2015: All travelers (staff or volunteers) must submit a Travel Authorization (TA) with proper authorization from supervisors for all POA travel. This includes any travel outside of headquarters, regardless of the destination or mode of transportation. Prior to booking any flights, hotel, trains, etc. with Travel Leaders Corporate. Travel Leaders Corporate will require an approved TA for all travelers before the request is processed. A sample Travel Authorization can be found at J:\Administration - Finance\FORMS, Requests, and Templates.

Effective September 1st, 2016 all travelers (staff or volunteers) will need to complete an online travel authorization form using the Salesforce platform. After September 1st, 2016 we will no longer be utilizing the Word document travel authorization, but rather all records and TAs will be stored electronically on the Salesforce platform. Travel insurance will also be requested online via Salesforce and a hardcopy will no longer need to be submitted to F&A. An electronic copy will be sent to F&A and once enrollment is completed, the staff member will receive an electronic confirmation email.

Proper TA's must include the following:

- Traveler's Full Name on Passport
- Address
- Gender
- Date of Birth
- Program/Administration Unit Traveling Under
- Purpose of the Trip/ Scope of Work to be Performed
- Dates of Travel
- Proposed Itinerary
- Signature of Authorization from Supervisor

The above-indicated documents should be reviewed and approved by the individual's supervisor. Additionally, the supervisor granting the approval for the trip must ensure that proper procedures related to travel notification/approvals from funding agencies are followed. All staff trips should be entered into the Staff Calendar in Outlook.

Expense Reports for Reimbursement

No later than 30 days following a trip, a Trip Report should be prepared and submitted to the Finance Office. This report should include the following:

- A fully executed Travel Authorization. After the trip has been completed, staff are responsible for submitting the TA sent to Travel Leaders Corporate, final copy of flight itinerary, hotel itinerary, and scope of work/travel itinerary (if applicable).
- An Expense Report should include all proper documentation, coding and receipts for all items over $25.
    - Please note that a bank or credit card statement is not sufficient documentation. An affidavit will need to be filled out confirming the expenses were for business purposes and that the expense did not include any alcohol.
    - Auto reload and prepaid cards are not permitted, instead the expense should be booked at the time of use.
    - All meal & meeting expenses must include a description of who the meal/meeting was with and the purpose of business
    - Itemized receipts are required for all food, beverage, material or hotel purchases. The receipt must list all charges related to the total receipt. Please note that if only the summary receipt of the total is provided, an affidavit will need to be filled out in addition, to confirm no alcohol or other unnecessary expenses* were charge.
        - *Unnecessary expenses included but are not limited to: non-essential upgrades, spa treats, hair services, nail services, entertainment expenses, etc. Please see list below of other non-reimbursable expenses.
- Provide evidence of the exchange rate during the period of travel (a hotel or bank receipt showing a conversion of currency may be a convenient way of satisfying this requirement.)

Non-reimbursable Expenses - Travel expenditures that are not reimbursable include:

- Additional travel insurance, travel accident insurance or trip cancelation premiums.
- Non-essential upgrades or packages.
- Additional expenses associated with the cost of first or business class airfare, unless it falls into the exception categories listed above.
- Childcare and babysitting expenses.
- Costs incurred by your failure to cancel transportation or hotel reservations.
- Costs incurred by your spouse or other dependents traveling with you, unless spouse or dependents is also on a POA assignment.
- Gasoline expenses when the automobile mileage reimbursement rate is claimed.
- Host/hostess gifts, in lieu of meals and lodging, when the cost exceeds what meal and/or lodging expenses would have been.
- Hair styling and haircut expenses.

- Spa, nails or other treatments.
- Entertainment expenses, unless activity is required by POA trip.
- Kennel/boarding expenses for pets.
- Costs incurred for speeding tickets, etc. when renting a vehicle for POA use.
- Other expenses not directly related to the business purpose of the travel assignment.

Please note that volunteers will be using the form below: Partners Volunteer Expense Signature Page

- Can be found here: J:\Administration - Finance\FORMS, Requests, Templates

An Activities Report, indicating the activities conducted during the trip, follow-up plans, partnership update and other information potentially useful to other Partners' staff. This report should be saved on the computer network (J:\Administration - Finance\Staff Trip Reports) and a notice should be sent to all interested staff informing them that the report has been saved in the appropriate folder and available to them. Please note that activities report submission depends on each department and team's needs. Your supervisor will let you know if a trip report is required.

Credit Card Reports

Please note that our policy regarding Delinquent Employee Credit Cards has changed and will be effective March, 1st 2017:

All employees are responsible for submitting their credit card reports to F&A by the due date set each month. Employees will receive the months' credit card report the last week of that month to submit by the due date (typically 2-3 weeks after distribution date). If an employee will be on Leave or Travel and will not able to comply with the due dates, they must inform F&A in writing and provide a date they will submit their report.

- If an employee fails to comply with the above guidelines and the due date has past, the Finance Officer will send a First Warning email notifying the employee and their supervisor of the delinquency.
- If the delinquency continues after the First Warning. A Second Warning email will be sent. This email will be sent to the employee, their supervisor, CFO/Controller and CEO.
- If the delinquency continues after the Second Warning. A Third Warning email will be sent. This email will be sent to the employee, their supervisor, CFO/Controller and CEO. The card will be suspended until report has been submitted to F&A.

Credit Card Suspension

If the employee fails to comply with the three warning emails and are delinquent more than 2 statements (about 60 days) the credit card will be placed on suspension so no additional charges may be incurred. Once the employee submits ALL outstanding statements the card will be reactivated for use.

Credit Card Probationary Period

If an employee has their credit card suspended due delinquency, they will face a probationary period upon reactivation of the card. The employee will be placed on credit card probation for 6 months following the occurrence. During the 6 month probationary period, if the employee is delinquent on ANY statement, the card will again be suspended until the statement can be submitted. Once an employee has their credit card suspended twice within a 6 month time period, a permanent record will be filed in their personnel file. If the employee has their credit card suspended three times within

a 6 month time period, the card will be cancelled. The employee will be re-eligible for a corporate card after a year. There will be no exceptions.

The Finance Office will be responsible for filing and safekeeping of all Expense and Credit Card Reports (these documents will be in the Finance Office or in storage for three years). All Expense Reports for the year must be submitted by the end of the calendar year. Failure to comply will be reflected in your Performance Review.

Travel advances

Staff travel advances should be requested before a trip. The request can be up to a maximum of 80% of the US Government Per Diem rate for the location to which you are traveling. The check request must be accompanied by a signed Travel Authorization. Check requests must be submitted two weeks before departure date to ensure adequate processing time. All advances should be cleared 30 days from the issued check date, unless the travel period extends beyond two weeks in which case, the staff member has 60 days to clear the advance.

Expenses Reimbursed by Other Organizations

For all expenses expected to be paid by other organizations, please send an email notifying the Finance Office of:

- Date of trip
- Specific expenses that will be reimbursed
- Fees associated with the transaction that may or not be acquired by POA
- Billing instructions including supporting documentation that may need to be provided

The Finance Office will assist with submission of invoices to the organizations for payment.

Personal travel

If, for personal reasons, the traveler wishes to go to places other than those on the authorized Partners itinerary, he/she may book and must pay for those reservations and additional costs directly through our travel consultants by major credit card only. The staff member should also notify F&A in writing that they are booking personal travel/personal portion of the trip. The staff member will be responsible for covering their personal travel within 30 days of the booking. If the flight cost is a cheaper ticket price including personal days on the beginning or end of the trip, the staff member does not need to reimburse any money. Staff members are only responsible for paying the difference of the round trip ticket. For example travel dates for business ticket cost = $500, travel dates including a personal portion of the trip = $600, staff must reimburse Partners the $100 dollar difference. Appropriate documentation showing the additional costs should be kept on file for audit purposes.

Fly America Act

All US government-funded Partners travel will comply with the Fly America Act, which requires that all travel and shipments must be made on U.S. flag carriers to the extent services by such carriers is available. More information can be found under J:\Administration - Finance\ADMINISTRATIVE GUIDE.

Travel Leaders Corporate

Travel arrangements for approved travelers are made through our travel agency, Travel Leaders Corporate. Effective August 1st, 2015: All travelers (staff or volunteers) must submit a Travel Authorization (TA) with proper authorization from supervisors for all POA travel. This includes any travel outside of headquarters, regardless of the destination and mode of transportation. Prior to booking any flights, hotel, trains, etc. through Travel Leaders Corporate, they will

require an approved TA for all travelers before the request is processed. Either of our main contacts can assist with travel plans although each unit usually has one representative they work with on a regular basis.

- Melissa Backenstow, MBackenstow@tlcorporate.com - 703-287-8985 (1-800-988-7745 ext. 4604)

Staff is also free to contact Travel Leaders Corporate's Strategic Program Manager with questions, concerns, or for assistance for more complicated requests such as large groups or conference planning.

- Judy Weber, Travel Leaders Corporatejweber@tlcorporate.com- 305-476-2790 – Office and 440-570-5902 - Mobile

Changes to Itinerates

A supervisor should approve their staffs' itinerary changes. After receiving approval from the supervisor, the staff member can contact Travel Leaders Corporate to make the necessary change. Most importantly, it is critical that the staff member notifies the F&A Office of changes if it is resulting in a flight cost differential (more or less expense than the original flight). In emergency circumstances when a supervisor is not available/ after hour changes must be made immediately, it is left to the discretion of the staff member; however they should inform F&A and their supervisor once the change(s) have been made.

Airfare

Only coach class or promotional fares will be paid by POA. Business and first class are considered seat upgrades and must follow the protocol below, otherwise will not be covered by POA.

Seat Upgrades

While seat upgrades are not to be expected, there are some circumstances when the traveler could be authorized to travel Business class, provided the proper documentation is retained for proof of why the upgrade was necessary:

- When no space is available in coach-class accommodation
- When use of business class is necessary to accommodate traveler disability or a special need
- With reason and prior approval from supervisor

Ground Transportation

The use of a personal vehicle while on travel permitted in lieu of airline transportation. The traveler will be reimbursed for gas mileage in accordance with the IRS standard mileage rate. The current mileage reimbursement is $0.535 cent per mile driven on business purpose https://www.irs.gov/uac/2017-standard-mileage-rates-for-business-and-medical-and-moving-announced

Audit

All travel documents must be submitted to the Finance Department with all attachments in a format that can easily demonstrate to the external auditors that the policy is being followed and that the internal control system is functioning.

Policy Oversight

This policy will be supervised by the CFO/Controller of Partners and recommendations for updates can be forwarded to that office by any officer of POA.

Travel Policy Education

All Staff is eligible for travel policy education session with F&A at their orientation and there will be periodic refreshers sessions with all Staff.

Executive Endorsement

This policy has been reviewed by the President's Council and has secured executive endorsement and is mandatory in how travel is conducted at POA.

Out of Policy Safeguard

If for any reason a staff member feels that they are out of policy, they need to secure approval from their respective Team leader. The F&A Team will determine how to respond to any violation of the policy.

Documents: E-Doc Nomenclature

Policy

Each of Partners of the Americas (Partners) departments should follow a clear procedure that addresses the importance of establishing consistent naming practices for electronic files that are prepared for distribution within Partners and with external partners. This procedure should accomplish the following: First, ensure that those receiving the files understand what the files represent. Second, organize and keep track of the files and reference them at a future date. Third, provide a reference to the date and editor of the file (if there is one).

Procedure

Naming e-Documents must contain sufficient information to describe the content of the document. The key to the naming convention is to create a meaningful succinct description. Keep file names short and relevant.

1. When naming files, it is important to always include the following information:
    a. Funder / Organization name / Project (if applicable)
    b. Document content summary
    c. Date prepared or edited (year, month, day)
    d. Initials of person preparing or editing if applicable.
2. The following detail includes an example on how to properly name a proposal file.
    a. First, it is important to include the "funder / organization name / project" first (if applicable). For example, when preparing the master narrative of a Department of State (DOS) Funded proposal for Youth Ambassadors, the file could start with:
        i. DOS YA
    b. Second, the file name will also need to include the content of the document. In this case, we are naming a master narrative so the file will be named as follows:
        i. DOS YA Master Narrative or DOS YA Narrative, etc.
    c. Third, the file will need to also include the date the document is prepared or modified. The date should first include the four digit year (all four digits are used to avoid confusion with the two-digit month), followed by the two digit month, and finally the two digit day. Both month and day should always use

two digits, even for the first 1 – 9 dates. The date should only consist of numbers and it should include hyphens (or periods) between the year, month, and day. For example:

i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-17

ii. Placing all of the digits is important so that when files are sorted, all similar documents will be paired together and the files will be arranged in chronological order by year.

1. REMEMBER: Once you receive a document with a date, if you edit the document on a later date, rename the document with the new date.

d. Lastly, if the document is edited, the initials of the editor should be included. For example, if the document was edited by Jane Doe, the file would be named as follows:

i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-17 jd

e. If this same document is edited again on the same day by John Smith, it would be named as follows:

i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-17 jd js

f. If, instead, the same document is edited a week later, for example on the 25th, by John Smith, it would be named as follows:

i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-25 jd js

g. Once a final version of a document is completed, the initials may be deleted and replaced with the word "final." For example:

i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-25 FINAL

1. It is extremely important to do this – in particular if there are various versions and these are documents that are considered official and given to a donor or some external agency.

3. Here are some other good examples of how documents can be named:

a. KLG Budget Draft 2014-03-01 jrm.xls (for a Kellogg budget proposal)

b. KLG Proposal Prep Timeline 2014-03-12 mc.doc

c. KLG Person Loading Chart Final.doc

d. USAID F2F Award letter 2015-08.doc

e. USAID F2F Program Description 2015-06 Final.doc

f. SENA 100K Cover Page Cost Proposal 2017.doc

g. SENA 100K Attach5 List of Contacts 2017.doc

Staff & Employment

Please see the Employee Manual for official policies regarding employment, leave, holidays, benefits, and other Human Resources issues.

Communicating Absences

All time out of the office must be marked on the Staff Calendar folder in Outlook with as much advance notice as possible. Staff members may email all staff about their travel plans if there is the possibility their time there might benefit other programs or units. However, emails to all staff about other absences are usually not necessary and should be kept to a minimum.

Updating voicemail

When staff are out of the office for more than a day, it is recommended that they set up their outgoing voicemail message so that people are informed that they are out of the office and when are they coming back, and possibly who will be covering for them during that time. In the "greetings" menu of your voicemail you have the option to record and switch to an "alternate" out-of-office message, then you can easily switch back when you return to the office.

Automatic reply

When staff are out of the office for more than a day, it is recommended that they set up an "automatic reply" on their email so that people are informed that they are out of the office, when are they coming back and who they should contact in case of an urgent issue. This can be configured in Outlook under the "File Menu" in the "Automatic Replies (Out of Office)" section.

Staff calendar

Whenever a staff member will be out of the office, it must be indicated on the Staff Calendar in Outlook along with information regarding times/dates and the reason for being out of the office (such as trip details, AL – Annual Leave, SL – Sick Leave, WFH – Work From Home, etc.). Details beyond that are not necessary for personal leave. However, additional information is required when the absence is due to business-related meetings, activities or trips.

When indicating that you'll be out of the office for travel, write the complete name of the event you're attending in the *subject* header. Use the *body* of the calendar note to provide additional information (even if only preliminary) on your activities or needs that could be helpful to either Program Development or Communications. For example:

- *Subject*: "Michelle in Guatemala for II Summit of Indigenous Journalists"

  Body: "Meeting with Shakira's people—what materials do I need to have on hand?"

If you are traveling to multiple locations, please note the change of location on the staff calendar, as well as if you are attending additional events using the same procedure as above.

Please indicate all possible travel on the Staff Calendar as early as possible. The Communications Unit maintains an editorial calendar that runs three to six months out, and in some cases more, so to guarantee that your needs can be covered we need to know about travel requiring communications support as early as possible

If you are planning a Partners event, please indicate the dates of the event on the Staff Calendar as early as possible. If your program participants are traveling/organizing their own events and you require communications support, please also indicate on Staff Calendar. For example:

- *Subject*: "Maria Gomez- CC Fellow- To International Water Conference Asuncion, PY"

  Body: "Maria needs a press release prior to the event. She also wants to speak to press in Asuncion about water rights."

Even if you are only out of the office in Washington, DC to attend an event, please indicate using the same procedures as above.

Late arrivals

Please be sure to alert your supervisor if you will be arriving more than 30 minutes late. Late arrivals generally do not need to be communicated to all staff.

Hiring of New Staff and/or Consultants

Staff

Information regarding the hiring process and other applicable documents can be found under J:\Administration - Finance\HR HANDBOOK\Pre-Employment

Consultants

Consultants (including interns) are hired based on specific scopes of work that are to be prepared by their supervisor. All contracts need to include:

- Scope of work
- Terms of payment and compensation rate
- Performance period
- Name of supervisor

The Finance Office has templates available for consultant contracts on the J: Drive at J:\Administration - Finance\Compliance\Templates\Consulting Templates and intern contracts at J:\Administration - Finance\INTERNS\Staff Resources. Once a contract has been prepared, it must be presented to the Finance & Administration Department for approval prior to being signed by the consultant or intern.

Consultants and interns do not accrue benefits and they are responsible for their own taxes regardless of citizenship. Partners provides the form 1099 at the end of the year for US-based payees. Consultants and interns are paid upon presentation of all reports, products and deliverables stated on their agreements. All travel expenses are verified and supported by backups and follow all staff travel policies. To issue a payment to a consultant or intern, a check or wire transfer request is to be prepared with all documentation listed above, and signed by a supervisor.

New Staff Orientation

All staff receive a new staff orientation during their first days at Partners. It is the responsibility of the supervisor, in coordination with the Finance & Administration Office, to ensure that the new staff member is adequately briefed by other staff.

The purpose of the orientation is first, to brief new employees on our activities and responsibilities so they can become as comfortable and productive as possible, as rapidly as possible; and second, to build from the start the sort of lateral communication across our organization that creates a healthy work environment and makes the whole greater than the sum of the parts.

The orientation has several elements.

- Official processing of employee (payroll, benefits, etc.) by the Finance & Administration Office and an overview of employee manual, policies and procedures
- Detailed introduction by the supervisor, focused on the job and its relationship to the organization
- Meetings between the new employee and the President

- Meeting with each Program or Unit Director to be informed about each program's mission, procedures, and possible relationships to the new employee's work
- Meeting with the Finance & Administration Office to explain policies and procedures pertinent to the new staff member's grant or unit, budget, etc.
- Employee initiative, to fill in holes and specific needs

For more information regarding the orientation and on-boarding process contact the Finance & Administration Office.

Staff Development

Partners encourages employees to attend presentations, workshops, or discussions on topics related to their professional interests as much as possible. Staying professionally current is a high priority. Financial support for training, conferences, coursework, and other forms of capacity-building that require a paid fee and/or time off from work, will be considered on an individual basis, guided by the following three categories:

1. Skills that are integrally involved in the most important responsibilities of the employee's position.
2. Skills that are involved in some aspects of the employee's position, but are not wholly and/or directly related to the most important.
3. Training, important for general development, but with no direct involvement in the employee's position.

Approval for training in Category 1 may provide for full reimbursement, training in Category 2 may provide for half and in Category 3 by discretion.

Reimbursement in all three categories is conditional upon available program and administrative resources. When possible, training for Categories 1 and 2 should be paid for by individual programs. When not possible, such training should draw on the Partners Professional Development administrative budget (if available). Category 3 will most likely depend on the Professional Development budget. Reimbursement in any category should be recommended by the relevant supervisor or grant manager, and approved by the Finance & Administration Office or the President.

Performance Evaluation

Good evaluations are multi-dimensional. Employees should have a self-evaluation in mind, and complete a form themselves. Good evaluations also include supervisor consultations with others who know the employee's work, including people in other offices or even outside Partners. This "360 degree" evaluation depends upon both the supervisor's initiative in seeking additional feedback, and proactive efforts of staff to provide such feedback to appropriate supervisors. The process should include all staff, from the President to every member at HQ and field offices.

The supervisor does the evaluation taking these various inputs into account to supplement his or her own perceptions. The supervisor should also seek feedback from the person being evaluated. Once the process is completed, an overall performance level is given and the form is signed by the employee and the supervisor. The supervisor submits these to the respective Vice President or directly to President, when applicable. The President submits these to the Finance and Administration Office within ten (10) working days for processing. Once the forms are processed, a copy of the final form can be requested from the Finance & Administration Office.

For official policies regarding performance reviews and salary increases, please consult the Employee Manual or contact the Finance & Administration Office.

Financial

Grant Numbers and Line Items

Partners' assigns grant numbers to all programs depending on the type of activity. These are generally designated as follows, with some exceptions.

- 90s – Administration
- 100s – Civil Society
- 200s – Education and Culture (Exchanges)
- 300s – Training
- 400s – Social and Economic Development
- 500s – Health
- 600s – Agriculture and Environment

Check Requests

Check requests are used for payments via check issued from the Finance Office. A copy of this form can be found on the J: Drive at J:\Administration - Finance\FORMS, Requests, Templates. Please include all necessary back up documentation when requesting a check.

- Write the "Payable To" name of the person or organization as you would like it to appear on the check.
- If the address you are providing is new or different than the last time a check was requested for this vendor, please bring it to our attention so the adjustment can be made in our system prior to printing the check.
- The coding section should be completed with assistance from your supervisor, as it directly affects the program or grant's budget. A list of possible Activities and Line Items can be found on your grants or units budget. If you need a copy please reach out to the Finance & Administration Department or your supervisor.
- Include a Customer Reference or Account Number, Invoice Number and Invoice Date if applicable.
- Whatever you write in the "Check Memo" section will appear on the check, and also as a description in our system and on reports. Because that is limited to a certain number of characters, you can provide more detailed information for the files in the space below.
- Person requesting and supervisor approval are necessary for payment.
- Checks over $10,000 require two authorized signatories to be in the office.

Completed requests should be left in the appropriate bin in the Finance Office. Check requests are processed on the 15th and last day of the month, if received by COB of the previous business day.

Wire Transfers

Wire transfers can be requested when the payee cannot receive the funds via check. Wire transfer requests can be found on the J: Drive at J:\Administration - Finance\FORMS & Templates. Please include all necessary back up documentation with your request.

The form allows you to provide the basic bank information necessary for most wires, but when sending a wire transfer to a new payee it is better for the payee to request instructions from their bank. Every country and sometimes banks have different requirements, and wires sent with bad information are not always returned to Partners.

- Write the "Payable To" name of the person or organization as it appears on their bank account.
- US Banks at a minimum require an ABA routing number and the account number. ABA numbers for wire transfers are often different than the routing number printed on checks, so the payee they should consult with their bank to confirm. They should also ask if any fees will be deducted, many US banks now charge customers for incoming wire transfers.
- International Banks at a minimum require the SWIFT code (all letters) and the account number. Many countries require more information, which is why it is best to have the payee ask their bank for instructions. Almost all international wires will have fees deducted by the recipient's bank, but the amounts can vary widely, so they should ask their bank before the payment is made.
- If Partners has sent a wire to a particular payee before, we may have saved their information for future wires. It is important to bring it to our attention if any bank information has changed from a previous request.
- The coding section should be completed with assistance from your supervisor, as it directly affects the program or grant's budget. A list of possible Activities and Line Items can be found on your grants or units budget. If you need a copy please reach out to the Finance & Administration Department or your supervisor.
- Include an Invoice Number and Invoice Date if applicable.
- Whatever you write in the "Memo" section will be included when the wire transfer is processed, and also as a description in our system and on reports. Because that is limited to a certain number of characters, you can provide more detailed information for the files in the space below.
- Please let the Finance Office know who should be alerted once payment is complete. Once confirmations are sent, the staff member who submitted the request is responsible for passing along the payment confirmations to the payee.
- Person requesting and supervisor approval are necessary for payment.

Since wire transfers take funds immediately from our bank account, we are unable to make wire transfer payments on a regular schedule. Transfers under $5,000 will generally be completed within two weeks, while larger transfers could take up to a month. Funds may not arrive immediately in the recipient's account, especially when transfers are made internationally. Please allow plenty of time for processing.

Wires via affiliate organizations

In some countries it is not always possible for us to make wire transfers directly to individuals' or even organizational accounts. Brazil is the most common example, but other countries may also be affected. In these cases, wire transfers will be sent to our partner organization in those countries, and they will make the payment on our behalf.

In these cases, submit a wire transfer request as usual. If the transfer cannot be made directly to the payee, the Finance Office will ask you to provide the payee's contact information so it can be forwarded to the appropriate person in the local office. These transfers can take much longer than ones made directly from our office, please allow for a long processing time.

American Express, VISA and Corporate Cards

Staff that travel frequently may have American Express and/or VISA cards issued in their names. The use of the cards is for business use only and all expenses must be reconciled monthly and submitted to the Finance & Administration Office by the due date indicated on the statement, which is usually 14 days after the statement is received.

Partners benefits from the use of corporate cards by accumulating points and rebates. For information about redeeming rewards or miles, speak with the Finance & Administration Office.

Procurement Policies and Procedures

Partners of the Americas acquires goods and services through various funds, including core and grant and contract funds. It is the policy of Partners to follow the requirements of OMB Circular 110 regarding the procurement of goods and services especially for U.S. government-funded projects. The nature of grants with the U.S. government and most other donors means that all costs incurred may eventually be audited by public accountants or the Inspector General's office. It is therefore essential to negotiate the most economical conditions for purchases. Procurement will be made with complete impartiality based strictly on the merits of a supplier's proposal and applicable related considerations such as delivery, quantity, after-sale service, etc.

The Finance & Administration Office is responsible for reviewing all bids and must ensure funds are available for purchases. All bids and purchase documents must be saved in the Finance Office for future audits. It is the policy of Partners of the Americas to procure only those items which are required to fulfill the objectives of grants and contracts, or those which are genuinely needed by the organization to meet its mission.

Please reference our Procurement Policy for complete details.

Petty Cash

The Finance & Administration Office manages a small petty cash fund which is used to reimburse or advance for expenses under $25. Receipts and a Petty Cash slip are required.

Communications

All information covered below is for general reference only. For detailed information on Partners' branding guidelines and communications policies, please reference the Communications Manual.

Partners Logos

Part of raising the visibility of Partners (which is directly linked to funding) is providing a consistent, high quality look. In keeping with this objective, branding experts recommend that we present our logo in a consistent fashion – this helps "brand" Partners in people's minds.

The Partners' Logo can be found in J:\External Communications and Outreach\Branding and Image. There are a few different logos for different situations, please consult with the Communications unit before including any logos in your publications or external communications. Here are some rules of thumb to keep in mind when using the logo:

- Should be displayed prominently (so that it is not hard to find) on all publications
- Should remain consistent – keep the mark consistent with the logotype

External Communication & Publications

Major external communication and printed publications must be reviewed by the Communications team before dissemination. The team will review for clarity of message and design considerations related to placement of logo and recognition of donors/sponsors. This will be done as expeditiously as possible, however please plan for a couple of revisions in your production process. It is also recommended to consult first with the Communications team to get some input up-front.

News releases

All programs are encouraged to periodically communicate their achievements and news (i.e. when launching a program, when significant achievements or events take place, final results, etc.). The Communications team is available to provide guidelines and suggestions. Program budgets should cover translation and printing costs whenever possible.

Stored publications

Partners stores and displays a variety of publications in the kitchen and attic. These include Partners' annual report, maps, folders, one-pagers, and event information. Any restrictions on the use of these items will be noted in the area they are stored in.

Web

Partners' website is http://www.partners.net. Take a look at the site and familiarize yourself with its contents. All teams and programs are responsible for maintaining current information on their programs in all relevant languages in consultation with the Communications team.

Business Cards

Please contact the Communications team to order or replenish Business Cards.

Pins

Partners has pins that are orange with the Partners logo. The price varies; they are usually sold at cost to volunteers and members. Please see the Communications Unit regarding payment for pins. Programs may have their own promotional merchandise more specific to their grant, which is produced in coordination with the Communications team.

Office & Equipment

Phones

The main phone number for Partners is (202) 628-3300 or Toll-Free (800) 322-7844.

Most staff direct lines are 202-637-6XXX, the last three digits being the person's extension (some intern extensions do not have a direct dial number). We did run out of 202-637-6XXX phone numbers so now all new phone numbers are (202)524-6XXX. The phone display will say which extension it is currently programmed for and the name associated with that extension.

Our phones use a Voice over IP (VoIP) system. There is an accompanying online portal called Office Suite. You can access our Office Suite portal by going to this web address:
https://officesuite2.broadviewnet.net/webadmin/login/202633AAAB

Quick start guides with a lot of useful information regarding the phones, online portal and voicemail system can be found under J:\Administration - Finance\ADMINISTRATIVE GUIDE\Phone Quick Start Guides. Many phone settings can be configured through the Office Suite portal such as call forwarding, call coverage, memory keys, etc.

Logging in / out of phones

To "log into" a phone, press the button (soft key) next to "ACTIVATE" on the phone's screen. Enter your extension number and pin, and press the "ENTER" soft key. To "log out" of a phone, press the following soft keys: "MENU" "LOGOUT" >"YES".

Outgoing calls

To make a call, lift the handset or press the key for the speakerphone.

- To call an internal extension, simply dial the 3-digit number.
- For domestic calls, dial **9 + 1 + Area Code + Phone Number** (even for 202 numbers).
- To call internationally, dial **9 + 011 + Country Code + Phone Number**. You have been assigned an international calling code which you will need to enter upon placing the call. Contact the Administration Officer if you need to request an international calling code.

Incoming calls

When you receive a call, it will say under the caller ID information "For: ___" to indicate if the call is to your direct line, your department group, the main line, etc. To change the ring tones for different types of calls, log into Office Suite go to "My Phone" → "Configure Ring Tones."

Main line

All interns, program and unit officers share the responsibility of answering the main line and lobby intercom line, and then assisting or directing callers. The main line and intercom line do not ring on everyone's phone, only those responsible for answering it.

Transferring calls

To transfer, while on a call, press the "Transfer/Confere" soft key or the button on the phone. Then enter the person's or group's 3-digit extension. The call will transfer when you hang up the receiver, so you can stay on the line and let the person know who is calling or simply hang up after you dial the extension.

Unlocking the elevator

Guests/Visitors using the intercom located outside of your main doors will appear as "**Douglas Dev**" on the phone. **To unlock the main doors press " 9 " on the phone keypad while on the intercom call.**

Be sure to ask who they are coming to visit at Partners before granting access. Also, let them know that they will have access to the elevator upon entering and to go directly to the 7th or 4th Floor.

Conference calls

Conference or three-way calls can be initiated once you are already on a call. Ask the current caller to hold, then press the "Transfer/Confere" soft key or the button on the phone. Dial 91 / 9011 + the number for the second caller. Once the second call is answered, press the "Transfer/Confere" key or button again to join the calls.

For conference calls requiring a larger number of participants, staff should utilize their InterCall Reservationless Plus account. Each employee was assigned a username upon employment. If you are in need of a user account please contact the Administration Officer.

Voicemail

To access your voicemail, press the button on your phone. Unless you are otherwise instructed, the default pin number is 1234. When you set up your mailbox for the first time it will prompt you to change it to something more personal.

Your voicemail greeting should say something along these lines: *"Hello – this is (name) (title or department) at Partners of the Americas. I'm either on the phone or away from my desk. Please leave your message at the sound of the tone and I'll return your call as soon as possible. If you need immediate assistance, press zero for an operator*."

Offsite voicemail access

When you're out of the office and you want to hear your messages by phone, call the main line 202-628-3300. Once the greeting begins, press * and the voice prompts will walk you through the steps. To access your voicemail online, visit https://voicemail.broadviewnet.com/Default.aspx?UserName. In the "Telephone Number" field enter our main number (2026283300), and then enter your extension and password (voicemail pin number).

There is also a Broadview Office Suite voicemail app available for iPhone and Android (search "Office Suite Voicemail" in the app store).

Office Supplies Purchases

Partners can purchase office supplies as need from lost cost providers. Partners has corporate discount accounts with Staples Advantage and Amazon. You may request orders at your convenience; however, all orders must be approved by the Finance & Administration Office.

Postage Meter

In the kitchen there is a Postage Meter machine which can weigh and calculate postage, then print the postage on envelopes or labels. Instructions can be found next to the machine. You must choose the grant or unit to be charged for the postage before using the machine.

Printers & Copiers

Partners has the following printers and copiers available:

- Ricoh 2352-4th Floor - B&W, Color, Copy, and Scan
- Ricoh C6501- 7th Floor – B&W, Color, Copy, Fax and Scan

Please contact mindSHIFT Technologies at 877-581-6508 to set up the laser printer closest to your desk.

For supplied or repair requests please contact the Finance & Administration Department. An order will then be place to order supplies or put in a repair requests.

Printer settings

Because Partners has supply and maintenance agreements with Centric/Ricoh, we pay on a per-page basis. Additional costs for color are charged based on the amount of color used on the page. We recommend using the "Green" settings

as your default printer settings, which is B&W and 2-sided printing. You can always override these settings before an individual print job if needed.

Sending faxes

To send a fax from the 7th floor RicohC6501 machine, select the "Fax" option on the home screen and type in the recipient's number before placing the documents in the scanning tray. Press the "Start" button to scan and fax the document.

Scanning

Both Ricoh copiers have the scanning functionality. On either machine, select the "Email" option on the home screen. Either search for your name in the address book or type your email address in the "To:" field. Set your scanning options, then press the "Start" button. A .pdf of your scan will be sent to the email addressed indicated.

Computer Support

MindShift is our computer/network support company and provides assistance through remote support (with on-site support when necessary). Contact information and ID number for your machine can be found on the sticker on your monitor or CPU. To access online support at https://support.mindshift.com, you can request a username and password from MindShift.

New users

New Partners user accounts and emails for intern or staff members must be requested by one of Partners' designated Points of Contact for IT matters, do not email MindShift directly with these requests. Requests must be emailed to Peggy Carlson (pcarlson@partners.net) with at least 48 hours advance notice. You will need to send them the full name of the staff member and also let them know the computer ID number where they will most likely sit (if you know that information). If the user needs special access, permissions, or if they should be in any particular email groups, please include that in your request.

Guest user

Visitors to our office or anyone who does not have a designated username can log onto a workstation using the "Guest" log-in:

- Username: poa.guest@partners.net
- Password: [password is changed regularly, you can request the most recent password from IT or F&A]

Wireless internet

The Partners office has two Wi-Fi hubs on each side of the office, the name of the network is PAR-Wireless and the access code is: 712f2441227978455c7b44577c

Shared address book(s) and distribution lists

There are several address books or distribution lists available to Partners staff through Outlook. The Global Address list includes all general addresses including staff, board of directors and partnerships. Updates to these lists should be emailed to Peggy Carlson.

An email can be distributed to the Partners staff that work in the DC Office by addressing an email to DCStaff@Partners.net. To email the entire Partners staff, including international affiliate organizations, an email can be addressed to AllStaff@Partners.net.

Public and private network drives

The Partners file network is organized by drives. A common J: Drive stores general information by function and is available to all staff. Each staff member has an individual drive to store personal documents (F: Drive) and many units have private shared drives. There is also an R: Drive for all digital images and videos.

J: Drive/J: Read-only drive

Please note all staff have access to a lot of useful documents in the J:\READ ONLY folder, such as current and past staff contact information, field office information, etc.

The Partners Directory is also located on this drive, and is continuously updated by Carmen Sepassi. As we are informed of changes in the chapters officers' mailing address, telephone and fax numbers, and e-mail address if any, they are updated and saved in the folder for easy accessibility. Please let Carmen Sepassi at csepassi@partners.net know if you have any corrections, additions, changes, etc. to any of these documents.

Virtual Private Network (VPN)

Partners has a Virtual Private Network (VPN) that allows staff to access private and common network drives from their work laptops from home or while travelling. Instructions for setting this up on your machine can be found under J:\Administration - Finance\ADMINISTRATIVE GUIDE\VPN Instructions.

Database

Partners has a database that stores information regarding volunteers, travel, partnerships, donors, organizations, programs and projects. It is an important tool for Partners and one we hope you will utilize frequently. Contact IT support for assistance setting up and accessing the database on your computer.

Security

New employees and interns should see the Finance & Administration Office to be assigned a building security key fob. The building security key fob is necessary 24 hours a day to access our suites and enter the building at all times. In case of loss the employee will be responsible for covering the cost of its replacement (currently $40).

Elevators

Visitors and deliveries must request access via the intercom located outside of the building's main doors. To unlock the main doors dial "9" on your keypad while on the intercom line. Be sure to meet the visitor or delivery at the elevator, or make sure the appropriate person is going to meet them. This system helps us keep our floor secure since there are limited concierge services in the lobby. Don't be afraid to ask who they are, whom they are here to visit or whom their package is for.

Alarm

Our security alarm system is provided and monitored by Kastle Security Systems. The main security alarm is located in Suite 700 and the reader is adjacent to the reception desk. The alarm will automatically arm and disarm- It will be armed Monday to Friday from 8pm to 8am, and disarmed from 8:01am to 7:59pm Monday to Friday. The security alarm will be armed all day Saturday & Sunday. In addition, Partners Suites located on the 4th Floor have a key reader located outside of the main door entry. Although these readers do not have a sensor tied to a siren, the activity is still monitored by Kastle. Furthermore, only Partners staff has the ability to arm and disarm the security alarm by swiping their key fob on the reader during nonbusiness hours. If the alarm is tripped Kastle will follow the set protocol- Kastle will notify the primary contact (Danielle Martin) with a phone call and a follow up email to inquire how to proceed. Kastle will follow the instructions given by the Primary Contact. Should the Primary Contact not be available, Kastle will then contact the secondary and tertiary point of contacts (F&A Team Members). Directors have been given 2 extra key fobs so that at

their discretion, they may assign it to their intern or consultant. The Director will be responsible for managing the two extra key fobs. For example, the Director will make sure to give and receive the key fob back from the intern or consultant upon start and ending of employment. Additional keys will not be given; each program may decide to purchase additional key fobs ($40 each) if needed. If Directors are informed that either of their extra key fobs is misplaced, lost, or stolen- the Finance & Administration Office will need to be notified immediately. At which time, a replacement key fob will be ordered and the cost of $40 each will be charged to the program/dept. Please make an important note of the following- key fobs assigned to interns and consultants will have restricted access. They will only have access to our suites during business hours from 8am to 5:30pm Monday to Friday - no weekend access, no exceptions.

Finally, to arm or disarm follow these steps:

To Arm- Swipe your key fob on the reader pad located adjacent to the reception desk. The light will go from green to red. You will have 30 seconds to clear the room. To Disarm- Swipe your key fob on the reader pad located adjacent to the reception desk. The light will go from red to green.

Safety

The health and safety of our Partners family is always our top priority, and everyone can play a part in making the Partners office a comfortable, secure environment. Before our elevators required a key fob to access our suites, we had a few instances of petty theft of personal possessions from employees' offices. There have also been reports of unauthorized persons in the lobby or building after hours, often getting past locked doors and elevators by coercing the cleaning crew or waiting for people to leave which gives them momentary access. While there have never been any major threats to the safety of our staff or office, we believe that vigilance and prevention are the best way to avoid possible dangers.

- If you feel uncomfortable for any reason, don't feel pressured to let someone onto the floor until you have verified that they have a legitimate reason for requesting access.
- When visitors call on the intercom, find out who they are there to meet and alert that person to greet them at the elevator or lobby. If the person they are meeting isn't available to greet them, meet them at the elevators or lobby yourself and accompany them to that person.
- For deliveries, even if it's not for you, go to the elevator to sign for or receive the package. Don't assume the staff near the elevators will always do this.
- If you encounter someone in the lobby, call or find the person they are meeting to confirm the meeting and let that person grant them access. Don't be afraid to say that you they can't ride up with you until that person gives permission.
- If they can't immediately name who they are meeting or why they want access, then it is a good clue that something might be wrong – especially after hours. Once an unauthorized man on the floor, when confronted about his reason for being there, said he was meeting the person on the first nameplate he saw (when in reality that person had left the office for the day).
- If someone is seeking access to another floor, don't get involved. The callbox in front of the building is a good place to direct visitors trying to access other floors.
- If you are working late in the office, check to see if others are here as well. Don't stay in the office late at night or leave by yourself. There is safety and comfort in numbers.

- If you feel unsure, don't get in the elevator or otherwise involve yourself in a situation with someone you don't know. If you find yourself in an uncomfortable situation, try to get away from it and when you are safe, call for help.

Remember that your safety and security should always be the first concern, and it is more important than any item we possess in our office.

Conference Room

Partners has a large conference room available for meetings. The large conference room located on the 7th Floor and seats approximately 30-40 people, depending on configuration. The room should be reserved in advance for meeting by signing up through the "Conference Rooms" shared calendar in the Public Folders in Outlook. Anyone is free to use this room at any time but meetings with reservations always have preference.

Staff members with larger offices should leave their offices neat and accessible while out of the office, so that they can be used by other staff for smaller, informal meetings.

Kitchen Duty

As we all use the kitchen at some point, we are all responsible for keeping it clean and organized. All staff will be assigned a week for kitchen duty, which you can trade with another staff member if you will be out of the office. Kitchen duty includes:

- Running the dishwasher at night
- Unloading the dishwasher in the morning
- Generally making sure the kitchen is clean and in order

Everyone is responsible for putting their dirty dishes in dishwasher and cleaning up their own mess on the counter, in the microwave, etc. as well as keeping the refrigerator clean and preventing overcrowding/spoiled food.

Green Initiatives

Partners is always looking for ways to make our office and work more environmentally-conscious. Here are some of our current "Green" initiatives, and we are always open to suggestions of new ways we can reduce our environmental impact.

Email signature

Encourage others to be more thoughtful about their printer usage by adding a line to your signature like this: Please consider the environment before printing this email.

Here is a website that can help walk you through the steps: http://www.ehow.com/how_5420224_insert-environmental-message-outlook-signature.html

Lights

Remember to turn off the lights in your office (if separate from the main lights) before you leave at night. If you are one of the last to leave to the office, help make sure the bathroom, conference room and kitchen lights are turned off. The last person to leave should turn off the main lights at the switch by the elevators before setting the alarm.

Recycle

DC law requires businesses to recycle, and around the office are different bins for trash, paper and other recyclables. Please be conscious of where you toss things, since we or the landlord could be fined if our refuse is not sorted correctly. Therefore, it's also a good idea to mark the bin(s) in your office using one of the three categories (trash, paper, or recyclables), so the cleaning company has no doubts about what to do with the contents.

There is a shredder near the mailboxes so you can shred documents with sensitive information before recycling. There is a 10-15 page limit that can be shredded at a time.

Reuse

Keep a bin or folder in your office to save scrap paper for expense reports (to attach receipts), notes, drafts, calculations, etc. Before throwing away a binder, folder, etc. that you no longer need, please remove the papers to be recycled/reused, and place the supplies back in the kitchen for someone else to us.

Set your printing defaults

Please contact mindSHIFT Technologies to help set up your printer defaults. See the section in "Printers & Copiers" for their contact information.